

Q1 Book work

Do it yourself

Q2 Answer the following questions briefly.

(i) What is the bhabar?

Ans Bhabar is a part of the Northern plains which is a narrow belt of about 8 to 16 km in width. It is enclosed with pebble deposits and is lying parallel to the slopes of the shiwaliks.

(ii) Name the three major divisions of the Himalayas from North to South?

Ans The three major divisions of the Himalayas from North to South are:-

1. The Great Himalayas (or) Himadri.
2. The middle Himalayas (or) The Himachal.
3. Shiwalik ranges.

(iii) Which plateau lies between the Aravali and the Vindhyan ranges?

Ans The Malwa plateau lies between the Aravali and the Vindhyan ranges.

(iv) Name the Island group of India having coral origin.

Ans The Lakshadweep group of Island has coral origin.

Q3 Distinguish between

(i) Bhangar and Khadar

Ans The old alluvium of the northern plains is called as Bhangar. It is that part of the plain which is not affected by flood water every year. Remnants of bhangar are eroded by every change in the direction of river channels. **While as** the new alluvium of the northern plains is

called Khadar. Here the flood water spreads almost every year and a layer of silt is deposited. These deposits are normally confined to the vicinity of the present river channels.

(ii) Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats

Ans The Western Ghats are situated on the west coast of India almost uninterruptedly along the Arabian sea. They have general altitude of 900-1100mts. They are mostly devoted for coffee cultivation. **While** as the Eastern Ghats are situated on the east coast of India along the Bay of Bengal. These are discontinuous hills. Their altitude rarely exceeds 900 mts.

Q4. Which are the major physiographic divisions of India? Contrast the relief of the Himalayan region with that of the Peninsular plateau.

Ans The major physiographic divisions of India are:-

- 1) The Great Mountain wall of the North.
- 2) The Great plateau of Peninsular India.
- 3) The Great Northern Plain.
- 4) The Indian Desert.
- 5) The Coastal Plains.
- 6) The Islands.

Below is given the contrast between the Himalayan region with that of the Peninsular plateau:-

The Himalayan Region	Peninsular Plateau
I. It consists of the loftiest mountains and deep valleys.	It consists of broad & shallow valleys and rounded hills.
II. It is formed due to collision of the Indo-Australian and Eurasian plates.	It is formed due to the breaking and the drifting of the Gondwana land.
III. It is formed at the edge of	It is formed at the edge of the

	the Indo-Gangetic plain.	Deccan plateau.
IV.	The Himalayan region contains only a few minerals.	The Peninsular plateau is the storehouse of the minerals.
V.	The rivers that originate from the Himalayas are perennial.	The rivers that originate from plateau are seasonal in nature.
VI.	It is composed of sedimentary rocks.	It is composed of igneous and metamorphic rocks.

Q5. Give an account of the Northern Plains of India.

Ans The Northern Plain extends from the Punjab plain in the west to the Brahmaputra valley in the east. This plain lies to the south of the Himalayas. This plain possesses the alluvial deposits of the Ganga, the Indus and the Satluj etc. The Ganga forms the largest part of it. The plain being about 2400kms long and 240 to 320kms broad is the densely populated division. With a rich soil cover combined with adequate water supply and favourable climate, it is agriculturally a very productive part of India. The Northern plains are known as “Food Bowl” or the “Grainery of India” because of its extensive cultivation. The Punjab plain forms the other part of the Northern plain. The Brahmaputra valley in Assam forms the eastern part of the Northern plain. It is narrower than the Ganga plain. It is a frequent flood area.

In the South-eastern side of the Northern plain lies the Ganga-Brahmaputra Delta which is very famous for its special characteristics.

Q6 Write short notes on the following

(i) The Indian Desert

Ans The Indian Desert, also known as the Thar Desert, is a large, arid region in the western part of India. It is the world's 18th largest hot desert. This area receives very low rainfall of below **150mm/yr**. Arid climate, sandy soil, sparse vegetation, absence of permanent rivers are the main features of the Thar desert. The Luni is the only river in the desert which originates in the Aravali range. Most parts of this desert are located in Rajasthan.

(ii) The Central Highlands

Ans It is the northern part of Peninsular plateau, denuded mountain range and low hills. This part is made of igneous rocks. The north-western part of plateau is occupied by Aravalli range which runs in the south-west north-east direction from Gujarat to Delhi. The Southern boundary of Central Highlands is made by Vindhya range. In between Aravalli and Vindhya range lies the Malwa plateau. The eastern part of Central Highlands is known as Bundel khand.

(iii) The Island group of India

Ans India has 2 set of Islands. One is known as Andaman & Nicobar Islands and the other is known as the Lakshadweep Islands.

The Andaman & Nicobar Islands lie in the south-east of the Bay of Bengal. They are chain of 233 Islands. Most parts of these Islands are covered by Tropical Rain Forests.

The Lakshadweep Islands lie in the south-west of the Arabian sea. They are composed of small coral Islands. They are horse-shoe shaped. The Island group has great diversity of flora & fauna.